

THE WAY

Community Forms & Templates

Companion, House of Prayer, Gathering, Commissioning, Teaching, Continuity & Health Review

Version 0.6 | September 19, 2026
Working language for UNDECIDED

The institution exists to serve the Way; the Way does not exist to preserve the institution.

Use of this packet

These forms are implementation aids. They should be customized to actual legal entities, safeguarding requirements, staffing, insurance, and local practice. A form does not create authority that the governing documents do not otherwise grant.

Form 1 - Companion Commitment Record

Name (optional public display name): _____

Date: _____

House / community, if any: _____

Method: public / private / written / other: _____

I choose freely to walk the Way in companionship with others. I affirm the Companion Commitment adopted by the Assembly. I understand that this is a religious commitment, not a civil contract or irrevocable vow, and that I may cease identifying as a Companion at any time without permission or penalty.

Signature or acknowledgement: _____

Witness / recorder (optional): _____

Form 2 - Companion Exit / Status Change Record

Name: _____

Date received: _____

Statement received through: _____

Administrative follow-up needed (property, records, payroll, housing, etc.):

A clear statement of departure is effective immediately. This form records administration only. No approval, confession, meeting, release, nondisparagement promise, or doctrinal recantation is required.

Optional note from former Companion: _____

Recorded by: _____ Date: _____

Form 3 - House of Prayer Recognition Instrument

House name / location: _____

Recognition stage: Gathering Circle / House-in-Formation / Recognized House

Recognition date: _____

Review date: _____

House Steward: _____

Safeguarding contact / independent escalation: _____

Corporate sponsor / responsible legal entity: _____

Minimum functions verified: regular gathering; prayer/worship; study/inquiry; service/mutual care; complaint route; safeguarding process; local stewardship.

Financial authority granted (if any): _____

Contracting/property/employment authority granted (if any): _____

Special conditions: _____

Recognition does not create a separate legal entity unless expressly stated in a separate legal instrument.

Form 4 - Gathering Plan

Gathering type: Prayer / Study / Service / Fellowship / Discernment

Date/time/location: _____

Facilitator(s): _____

Expected participants: _____

Safeguarding considerations: _____

Accessibility considerations: _____

Purpose: _____

Minimum elements: _____

Optional elements: _____

Materials / sources: _____

Feedback / follow-up: _____

Form 5 - Ministry Commissioning Record

Person: _____

Commissioned role: Teacher / Minister / Steward / other _____

Scope of authority: _____

Start date: _____

Term / review date: _____

Supervisor / review body: _____

Required training completed: _____

Safeguarding/background review completed where applicable:

Boundaries / prohibited actions: _____

Complaint route communicated: yes / no

Compensation or expense arrangements (if any): _____

Commissioning grants only the authority stated here and does not create spiritual supremacy, fiduciary power, or immunity.

Authorized by: _____ Date: _____

Commissioned person: _____ Date: _____

Form 6 - Teaching / Doctrine Proposal Record

Proposal title: _____

Proponent(s): _____

Status requested: teaching / doctrine / permitted interpretation / open question

Current confidence level proposed: _____

Proposition: _____

Primary sources / evidence: _____

Historical context: _____

Competing interpretations: _____

Strongest arguments for: _____

Strongest arguments against: _____

Rights / safeguarding / governance impact: _____

Dissenting views recorded: _____

Decision / status: _____

Review date: _____

Form 7 - Founder-Exit Continuity Exercise

Exercise date: _____

Scenario: death / incapacity / resignation / extended absence / disagreement

Participants: _____

Can executive operations continue? yes / no / partial

Can worship and teaching continue? yes / no / partial

Can finances and banking continue? yes / no / partial

Can safeguarding and complaints continue independently? yes / no / partial

Can governing bodies meet and act? yes / no / partial

Can public communications continue? yes / no / partial

Can the archive / doctrine record be accessed? yes / no / partial

Single points of failure discovered: _____

Remediation owners / dates: _____

Form 8 - Annual House Health Review

House: _____

Review period: _____

Reviewers: _____

Regular gatherings sustained?

Prayer and study both present?

Service / mutual care active?

Safeguarding training and reporting information current?

Complaint channel known and accessible?

Any retaliation, shunning, or coercive-exit concern?

Any leadership concentration concern?

Any financial exceptions / undocumented cash / related-party issue?

Can participants disagree safely?

Can participants leave safely?

Can the House function without one particular leader?

Actions / due dates: _____

Implementation Checklist

- Approve v0.6 for pilot use, not final constitutional status.
- Train founding leaders on Companion rights, exit protections, safeguarding, complaint independence, and epistemic distinctions.
- Pilot at least one Gathering for Prayer, one Gathering for Study, one Gathering for Service, and one Gathering for Discernment.
- Operate the first recurring group as a Gathering Circle before recognizing a House of Prayer.
- Collect anonymous and open feedback from participants, including criticism and exit feedback.
- Do not commission ministry roles until real functions and supervision exist.
- Run a founder-exit continuity tabletop exercise before public launch and at least annually thereafter.
- After a pilot period, reconcile v0.6 with bylaws, policy manuals, public website language, and tax-exemption narrative.